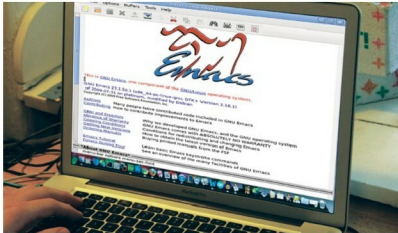


A Brief on Search, Frames and Windows in GNU Emacs



We have been carrying articles on GNU Emacs for quite some time now. This is one more article in the series.

In this next article in the GNU Emacs series, we shall learn how to perform text search in a buffer, and introduce the concept of windows and frames.

Search

You can copy the following poem, which I wrote in 2013, in the *scratch* buffer or a file inside GNU Emacs to try out the search commands:

```
Emacs is an operating system
Which unlike many others, is truly a gem
Its goodies can be installed using RPM
Or you can use ELPA, which has already packaged them
```

```
You can customise it to your needs
You can also check EmacsWiki, for more leads
Your changes work, as long as reload succeeds
And helps you with your daily deeds
```

```
People say it lacks a decent editor
But after using its features, they might want to differ
Using Magit's shortcuts, you might infer
That it is something, you definitely prefer
```

```
Plan your life with org-mode
You don't necessarily need to write code
TODO lists and agenda views can easily be showed
Reading the documentation can help you come aboard
```

```
Emacs is a double-edged sword
Its powerful features can never be ignored
```

Customisation is possible, because of free software code
And this is my simple ode.

You can search for a word in a buffer using the `C-s` short cut. You will then be prompted with *I-Search*: in the mini buffer, where you can type any text and GNU Emacs will try to find words matching it, in the buffer. This is an incremental forward search and is case insensitive. Thus, if you search for the word 'todo' in the poem, it will match the string 'TODO'. You can exit from the incremental search using the *Enter* key, or abort the search using the `C-g` key combination. If you want to do an incremental search in the reverse direction - from the cursor position to the top of the buffer -- you can use the `C-r` short cut.

If you place the cursor on the letter 'E' in 'Emacs' in the poem's first line, and press `C-s C-w`, Emacs will try to find all occurrences of the word 'Emacs' in the text. Suppose you have cut or copied text to the kill ring, you can search for this text by using the `C-s C-y` short cut. You can repeat the previous forward search using `C-s C-s`, and the previous backward search using `C-r C-r` short cuts.

The first occurrence of a text can be looked up in the forward direction using `C-s`. This will prompt you in the mini buffer with a *Search:* string, where you can type the text that you want to search for, and then press the *Enter* key. It will then search for the text and move the cursor to the matching word. This is a non-incremental forward search. Similarly, you can perform a non-incremental backward search using `C-r`. You can then input the search string to be searched for, followed by the *Enter* key.

Regular expression searches are very useful too. In order